

▼ SANNAI-MARUYAMA

Jomon people were living in permanent settlements by around 3500 BCE. The largest of these was the Sannai-Maruyama settlement in northern Japan.

Clay figures, tools, and the remains of longhouses, have been found here.



▲ RITUAL BELLS

Metalworking was introduced to Japan during the Yayoi period. Archaeologists have found decorated bronze bells, called dotaku, at Yayoi sites. Often decorated with images of animals, water, or agricultural objects, the bells may have been used in rituals for good harvests.

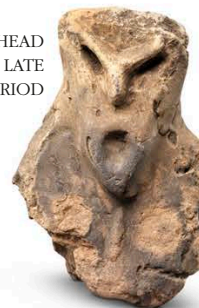
DOGU FIGURINES

Small human- and animal-like figurines, called *dogu*, were made during the Jomon period. Although historians are not exactly sure what their purpose was, they think they might have been used as part of religious rituals, such as to heal the sick or to promote fertility.



DOGU HEAD
FROM LATE
JOMON PERIOD

DOGU HEAD FROM
MIDDLE JOMON PERIOD



DOGU
FIGURE
FROM FINAL
JOMON
PERIOD

Wide hips
were typical of
dogu figurines.



◀ BURIAL SITES

The Kofun period gets its name from large burial mounds known as kofun built for important people such as emperors. Kofun burial mounds came in various shapes but most commonly had an unusual keyhole-shaped design, as seen in the Daisen Kofun (left) located near the city of Osaka—the largest kofun ever found.



▲ HANIWA FIGURES

People from the Kofun period built terra-cotta clay figures called haniwa. Molded into depictions of warriors, birds, boats, weaponry, and the like—haniwa were placed around Kofun tombs, possibly to serve and protect the dead in the afterlife, but also to mark where the burial sites were located.